

Advanced Valuation Settings:

Currency Year and Income Growth

Inflation Adjustment

Inflation Dataset: EPA Standard Inflation

Currency Year: 2010

Income Growth Adjustment

Income Growth Dataset: EPA Standard Income Growth

Income Growth Year: 2010

Endpoint Groups:

- Acute Bronchitis
- Acute Respiratory Symptoms
- Asthma Exacerbation
- Chronic Asthma
- Chronic Bronchitis
- Lower Respiratory Symptoms
- Mortality
- Upper Respiratory Symptoms

Select the income growth dataset, then the year and the endpoint groups to which you want to apply the adjustment. You may select more than one endpoint group.

Cancel OK

Inflation Adjustment

The **Inflation Adjustment** needs to be carefully considered in relation to the valuation dataset that you are using. (This is discussed in detail in the section on loading inflation data in Chapter 4.) The default valuation database in the *United States* setup has a currency year of 2015, so the inflation dataset has a value of 1 for the year 2015.

Income Growth Adjustment

Willingness to pay (WTP) estimates are believed to be tied to the income of individuals. As income rises over time, WTP estimates are likely to increase as well. The **Income Growth Adjustment** is designed to take this phenomenon into account, allowing you to account for income growth between the time when WTP estimates were calculated and the year of your analysis.

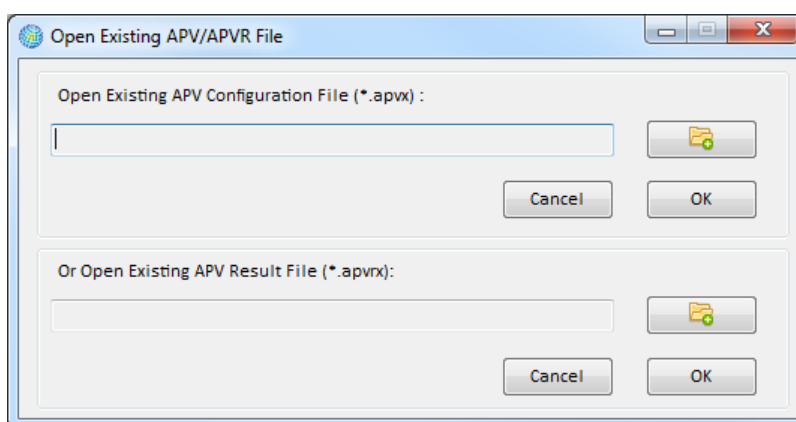
As with the **Inflation Adjustment**, the **Income Growth Adjustment** has a close connection to the valuation estimates. For example, the valuation estimates in the *United States* setup are assumed to be based on income levels from 1990, so the income

growth adjustment database has a value of 1 for the year 1990. (This is discussed in detail in the section on loading income growth data in Chapter 4.)

To use the **Income Growth Adjustment**, you need to choose a dataset and then choose the income year that you want to use. By default, BenMAP-CE sets the Income Growth Year equal to the user-specified Population Year or to the latest year for which income growth adjustment data are available if less than the population year.

7.3 Open & Modify Existing APV Configuration

If you have an existing APV configuration (*.apvx) file or APV result file (*.apvrx), you can open, and edit it. Double click **Aggregate, Pool & Value** from the main tree menu to load the APV Configuration or APV Result file.



If you have only a few changes to make to an existing configuration, it is typically much quicker to open the previous configuration, rather than entering all of your choices again. Note that the various parts of an APV Configuration are quite interdependent, so modifying part of the configuration may cause other parts to be reset. For example, modifying the tree structure for incidence pooling will cause the valuation method selection and valuation pooling tree structure to be cleared and reset. Changing the **Configuration Results Filename** in the **Select and Pool Incidence Estimates** window will not reset the incidence or valuation pooling trees as long as the new file contains incidence results generated from the same health impact functions as the old file. This can be quite helpful for generating new APV Configuration Results from several different Configuration Results files which were generated from different baseline/control scenarios, but with the same set of health impact functions.

7.4 Run APV Configuration

After having specified the various aggregation, pooling, and valuation options, you can save your APV Configuration for future use. The file that you save has an “.apvx” extension. The configuration that you have specified for APV is similar to the configuration that you developed for choosing health impact functions. (That configuration has a “.cfgx” extension.) Both files allow you to save choices that you have made, and re-run them at a later time.

To save your APV configuration with your valuation pooling choices, click the **Save As (*.apvx)** button, and name your configuration file. We suggest that you save this in the Configurations folder. When ready to generate APV Configuration results, click the **Run As (*.apvrx)** button. BenMAP-CE then requires that you specify a file in which to save the results, with an “.apvrx” extension.

7.5 View and Export Pooled Incidence and Valuation Results

Using the results from the APV Results file (“.apvrx” extension), you can create, view and export reports that reflect the choices you made about how to aggregate, pool and value your results.

7.5.1 Pooled Incidence Results

The **Pooled Incidence Results** report provides results aggregated and pooled to the level that you previously specified in the Aggregation, Pooling, and Valuation Configuration file. This report has fewer Health Impact Function fields than the **Aggregated Incidence Results Report**, and values for others will be blank. This is because after pooling, only enough fields are retained to uniquely identify individual results.

To generate pooled incidence results, click the **Pooled Incidence** tab in the upper portion of the main window. Double-click to select the study results you would like to view. The selected results should show up in the **Data** tab below, if not, click the **Show Results** button. Notice that you cannot re-aggregate the results in this stage, because you have already defined how to aggregate the results. You may also view the results on a map using the **GIS Map** tab and on a bar chart using the **Chart** tab.

7.5.2 Pooled Valuation Results

The **Pooled Valuation Results** report presents valuation results aggregated and pooled to the level you specified using the **Advanced** button when creating the APV configuration file. As with the **Pooled Incidence Results Report**, fewer Pooled Valuation Method fields are available, because only enough fields are retained to uniquely identify individual results.

Click the **Pooled Valuation Results** tab to begin viewing these results. Similar to the Pooled Incidence Results, you can double-click the study of interest and view the results table in the **Data** tab. Similarly, you may view the results on a map using the **GIS Map** tab and on a bar chart using the **Chart** tab.

7.6 Frequently Asked Questions

I am at the BenMAP-CE valuation window and cannot proceed. What should I do?

In order to proceed to the next step, you must select a Variable Dataset from the drop-down menu in the Select Valuation Methods, Pooling, and Aggregation window. The

files in the Variable Dataset can include a variety of data, such as income and poverty data that might be used in health or valuation functions. For the default EPA health and valuation functions, you just need to select the EPA Standard Variables.

If you have developed your own setup, then you need to make sure that you also load a Variable Dataset. This is necessary even if you do not need the extra variables that can be included in this dataset.

How do I edit or add other valuation functions?

To edit or add valuation functions you need to go to Modify Setup option in the Tools drop- down menu available in the upper left-hand corner of the main BenMAP-CE window. See the valuation function section in the chapter on Loading Data for details on how to do this.

How do I know what year dollars (currency year) were used?

You can find the answer in the Audit trail for the APVR file that you generated.

Do the currency year and year of the population data have to match?

No. The currency year and the year of the population data do not need to match. Currency years are always historical because we do not forecast inflation.